Moving Countries Is Better Than Looksmaxxing - Wheat Waffles

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📋 Executive Summary

Recorded on a yacht in Greece, two self-improvement creators — the host and Wheat Waffles — argue that geographic relocation, real-world social skills, and stable living beat looksmaxxing, chronically-online influencer advice, and flashy status signalling for building a genuinely good life.

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🏠 Setting & Context 0:00

- The podcast is recorded on a yacht in Greece, part of one of the host's "Onem trips" — group experiences he runs multiple times per year
  - The host notes the first podcast was recorded in his Cheltenham house; the contrast with the yacht setting is used to illustrate how much both men have grown
- Wheat Waffles is described as looking "jacked" — visibly transformed physically since their last appearance together roughly three years prior
- Several community members are also on the boat; the host credits the members for making trips like this possible
- Both men position themselves as mid-tier creators: "big" = 1M+ subs, "medium" = ~100k, "small" = ~10k; they describe themselves as "pretty well-known" within the niche

💊 Black Pill vs. Doomer Mentality 0:22

- Wheat Waffles says he still believes in many of the frameworks he articulated in earlier videos and podcasts
- He rejects the common misconception that "black pill" means giving up
  - His framing: black pill is about *acknowledging reality honestly* — recognising the hand you've been dealt — then maximising it
  - "Everyone's been dealt different hands, but it's about making the best of those"
- Example of the hand metaphor: being 6'2" is a better starting hand than 5'8", but everyone must play their own cards
- He distinguishes his approach as "black pill self-improvement" — realism without nihilism

🧴 Looksmaxxing Culture & Its Decline 1:33

- The host praises Wheat Waffles as "the original" clavicular/looksmaxxing content creator and expresses frustration that newer creators got more fame despite arriving later
- Both agree the new generation of looksmaxxing content has taken "a significant turn for the worse"
  - It has become more divisive rather than constructive or uplifting for men
  - Referenced creator (Clvicular) is described as "running around like a wild goose, causing trouble, getting arrested" — the content is framed as chaos for views rather than genuine self-improvement
- Financial incentive is cited as a key driver of the degeneration
  - "Camp Looksmax" is mentioned as a possible attempt to compete with the host's community business — host declines to comment substantively but says "I don't think it's competition"
- A study is cited (no formal reference given) suggesting that **up to age 22–23, women primarily care about looks, but after that, looks stop being the dominant factor**
  - Conclusion drawn: spending 100% of effort on looks optimisation is a poor long-term life strategy because its relevance expires in your early 20s
  - "Every year after 22, everything that you've put 100% of effort into is no longer going to matter"
- Youth is framed as roughly ages 16–22 — after that, societal expectations shift to jobs and adult responsibilities, making looks-focused strategies even less relevant

🌐 Online vs. Reality: The Basement Dweller Trap 3:07

- Both men describe themselves as "two of the only normal guys in the whole industry" — both have real girlfriends, met in real life, not sourced through clout or social media
- Core critique: many influencers can only attract women by **leveraging social media clout and displayed wealth**, which attracts clout-chasing and OnlyFans-type women — not healthy relationship material
- The "basement dweller" audience profile:
  - Age 15–22, large amounts of free time
  - Has never approached a girl in real life

    - Watches 6–8 hour streams daily
    - Extrapolates cherry-picked viral clips (e.g. a "5/10 woman rejecting a 9/10 man") to form their entire worldview
    - Donates money (e.g. £10) to multimillionaire streamers
    - Spams "W's" in chat as social validation
- Wheat Waffles shares a real-life anecdote: a friend told him 2 months prior that 3 years ago he was watching Myron Gains streams for **6 hours a day**, fully brainwashed, spamming chat — and later realised he "was just one of these sad losers" and escaped
- The content loop that makes this viral:
    - Streams find the most outrageous clips of delusional women
    - Basement dwellers, who are online the most, engage most and make it go viral
    - "People in the real world, their opinions matter more, but they're not watching 6-hour streams — maximum 30 minutes then back to real life"
- Real-world people don't know who these influencers are: "Andrew who? Never heard of him" — the online sphere dramatically overestimates its own cultural footprint
- The invisible success story: people quietly building businesses, having daily conversations with new people — they're not visible online but are the ones who succeed long-term

👥 Why Mainstream Influencers Are Out of Touch 6:07

- Named influencers discussed critically:
    - **Myron Gains** — credited with starting the long-form stream format (3–4 hour streams)
    - **Clvicular** — described as carrying it on; streams from his apartment, accused of gambling streams for sponsors, arrested multiple times, faces serious ongoing legal allegations
    - Another unnamed podcast doing 8-hour daily streams
    - **Andrew Tate** — example of fame leading to legal consequences ("handcuffs")
    - **Russell Brand** — cited as example of old on-camera statements leading to current allegations
    - **Charlie Kirk** — mentioned as facing significant public backlash roughly one year prior to recording
- The "Paris test" — when Clvicular went to Paris instead of Miami, the host says the approach didn't work: "when it's outside of Miami, trust me, it won't work — that same sh*t won't work because they're not looking for it"
    - Miami is "the capital of the world where clout-chasing girls are" — that environment is not transferable
- College social dynamics are dismissed as not real life: "sex on a Wednesday night when somebody's got nothing better to do" — not applicable to the remaining 50–60 years of adult life
- Key observation about longevity: "It's more important to survive every single year. Just survive. Be the last man standing — you tend to win"
- The David Beckham contrast: calm, gracious with fans, no drama — vs. Tate-style loud boasting that invites legal and social consequences

💬 Hate Comments & Who Actually Leaves Them 18:11

- Observation: hate comments consistently arrive within the **first 5 minutes** of a video upload
  - Employed people won't comment until 8 hours later after work, or the next day, or the weekend
  - Someone commenting at **1 p.m. on a Monday** almost certainly doesn't have a job
- These early comments accumulate likes quickly because they're posted first — the commenter mistakes that for validation: "I knew I was right"
  - In reality, the commenter likely hasn't watched even the first half of a 20+ minute video
- Wheat Waffles says he's shifted from firing back at hate comments to feeling genuinely **empathetic**: "to be that angry at somebody else, you must be going through some sh*t"
- The host anticipates comments on this very podcast calling them "two sub-fives" — and points out the person writing that is probably 35% body fat, living on government benefits, and miserable

💍 Marriage, Prenups & Relationships 19:44

- The host says he was formerly heavily anti-marriage but has softened: if the woman is a virgin with no prior high body count, he now views marriage as a potentially good trade — loyalty and genuine connection in exchange for some wealth
  - Historical framing offered: in older societies, a man "got" his wife's full loyalty and she became "queen of the kingdom" — a real, binding social contract
- His two **key screening criteria** for a long-term partner at age 34:
  - Poor relationship with father
  - High body count
  - Studies cited (no formal reference) show higher female body count correlates with **higher divorce rates** and **lower marriage satisfaction** — "worst of both worlds"
- Prenup nuance:
  - Without a prenup, you have the **government's prenup** (you're just following state rules)
  - Making your own prenup means you set the terms — but those terms should still account for children's welfare
  - Scenario given: married 10 years, 3 kids, then divorce — keeping every asset leaves the ex-wife and children in a one-bedroom flat, which is unrealistic and not what a good man would actually want
  - Conclusion: some financial provision for ex-wife and children is reasonable and morally sound, not weakness
- Both men feel this is less of a risk for them because they meet women in real life — not from clout-chasing circles
- Clvicular's legal allegations used as a case study: the woman involved is characterised as a clout-chaser who used legal allegations as "her ticket back into the clout sphere" — the host says this scenario would be impossible for him given how he sources relationships

- Both men explicitly avoid posting girlfriends online: "If I posted my girl online, people now know who she is — it's dangerous"

🌍 Moving Countries: The Core Argument 29:58

- Wheat Waffles' **single biggest piece of advice: move sooner**
  - His father gave him the same advice
  - Concept referenced: **Nomad Capitalist's** "go where you're treated best"
- Why he moved — dating market:
  - Western dating apps are statistically rigged against men
  - Even real-life dating in the West is increasingly hostile due to cultural shifts and "infinite options" dynamics driven by apps
  - After moving, he received **better treatment from better-looking women while changing absolutely nothing about himself**
  - Favourite phrase coined: **"marginal treatment from marginal looks"** — in the West, even above-average men receive dismissive treatment from average women
- Community evidence: multiple members in the Onem community have moved countries and report the same outcome — better-looking women who want less and treat men better
- The "they'll use you for money" counterargument is dismissed:
  - Wheat Waffles says he's paid for more dates and been offered to split the bill *less* in the West than in the countries he's moved to
  - Women in "men should provide" cultures often still split bills because they *value* the man, not just his wallet
  - ~50% of Americans don't have a passport — the people making this argument have never left to test it
- Western women critique (stated "respectfully"):
  - More invested in Instagram, travel, careers (e.g. HR jobs) than in relationships with men
  - Men feel increasingly unnecessary or unwanted in Western social structures
  - After a hookup in the West, it's often the **woman** who ghosts — not the man — because she has thousands of options; mainstream media has this dynamic backwards
- The pickaxe analogy: "If you've got a pickaxe, don't go to the farm looking for a job. Go to the people who are mining."
- Caveat: the host warns against endlessly chasing cheaper and cheaper countries (Philippines → Vietnam → somewhere even cheaper)
  - "Eventually you just have to give that up and say I'm going to have to work on myself"
  - The goal is to go where you're *treated* best, not where things are *cheapest*

💰 Geographic Arbitrage & Financial Freedom 42:11

- Core financial argument: **same income, radically different purchasing power**

Location	Monthly Cost of Living	Net Savings on £/€20k income
London	~£7,500/month	~£1,000/month
Greece / Romania / Bulgaria / South Italy	~£500/month	~£19,500/month

- Budapest anecdote: the host met a man who explained the concept simply
  - "If you're making 20k but spending 19k, you've got 1k/month. If I'm making 2k but my bills are 500, I'm richer than you."
  - Finance workers in the UK earning £8k/month might keep only £1,200 after costs
- Western tax burden framed as working for:
  - The government
  - Benefits recipients
  - An unsustainable healthcare system (aging population, underfunded pensions)
  - Immigration costs
  - "The worst age to be is 25–40 as a working man in one of these countries"
- The host's current situation: owns his house outright, lives for free, does frequent trips, better quality of life and relationship than when spending £7,500/month in London
- The yacht trip itself used as proof of concept:
  - Greece is cheap relative to Monaco or Miami
  - Split across a large group, the cost is very manageable — "it's fine"
  - Contrasted with renting a Lambo for a day (~$300 max) vs. a McLaren 720S at ~£2k/month
  - Host's pool heater in Granada cost £4k to buy and install — more than the monthly supercar rental — "people aren't going to celebrate a pool heater"
- Influencer wealth illusion: renting Lambos for a single-day shoot, borrowing a friend's car, or staging luxury for content — audience assumes the creator is rich
- Happiness observation: "The happiest people in Spain are walking hand-in-hand with their girlfriend, eating a £5 ice cream on the beach"
- Caveat for people on government benefits: leaving the country means losing those benefits — this strategy only works if you have an independent income or online business
  - Two or three community members on the boat are doing exactly this successfully

🏁 Closing Advice & Sign-Off 35:53

- Wheat Waffles' one piece of advice to younger men or men watching their journey: **move — and move sooner than you think**
- He reflects that the mainstream advice to "touch grass" that the manosphere used to mock was actually partially correct
  - Studies and internet videos are a narrow scope of the world

    - Most studies on dating dynamics are conducted in America or the West — results would look "wildly different" in Greece, Japan, South Korea, Thailand, Indonesia
    - The famous Tinder experiment (woman gets a million matches in a day) is a Western phenomenon — do the same experiment in Ukraine or Russia and results are completely different because attractive women there are abundant
- The host's complementary framing: "go where you're treated best — with women, with money, with what kind of house you can get for a reasonable amount"
- Both men express mutual pride in each other's growth since the first podcast (3 years ago, in a Cheltenham house)
- Community vision stated: "real people, real life people, all coming together, all helping each other — that's what the community should be"
- Podcast ends as the yacht picks up speed and becomes too loud to continue

> "In the West, even if you're an above-average looking guy, you'll be surprised by how often you get marginal treatment from women with marginal looks. All they did was move from one location to another and all of a sudden the treatment is way better — and they changed nothing about themselves."